

INTERNAL

Customer Support SLA & Escalation

Priority definitions, response targets, communication standards, and escalation policy.

OWNER	EFFECTIVE	STATUS
Customer Operations	15 July 2026	Approved / quarterly review

Scope

This policy defines customer support priorities, response targets, communication cadence, and escalation routes. Targets begin when Northstar receives a support request with sufficient information to identify the account and reported impact.

Priority matrix

PRIORITY	CUSTOMER IMPACT	FIRST RESPONSE	UPDATE CADENCE
Sev-1 Critical	Production unavailable, confirmed security event, or widespread critical access loss	15 minutes, 24 x 7	Every 30 minutes
Sev-2 High	Major function unavailable with no reasonable workaround	30 minutes, 24 x 7	Every 60 minutes
Sev-3 Normal	Degraded function or localized issue with workaround	4 business hours	Daily
Sev-4 Request	Question, documentation issue, or feature request	1 business day	On material progress

Intake requirements

- Customer name, workspace identifier, authorized contact, and preferred communication channel.
- Incident summary, observed start time, affected users or systems, business impact, and any workaround.
- Relevant correlation IDs, screenshots with secrets removed, and reproduction steps where safe.
- Explicit notice if the issue may involve security, privacy, billing, or data integrity.

Escalation rules

Escalate immediately to the incident commander when a Sev-1 is confirmed, when more than three enterprise customers report the same failure in 30 minutes, or when a workaround introduces security or data-integrity risk. Escalate to Security & Compliance for suspected unauthorized access, secret exposure, cross-tenant visibility, or approval bypass.

Communication standard

Every update must state: current impact; confirmed facts; actions completed with evidence; actions in progress; decisions or information required from the customer; and the next update time. Do not state that an incident is resolved until technical verification and customer confirmation are both recorded.

Service-credit handling

Support staff and agents must not promise credits. Record the request in HubSpot and route it to Customer Success. Credits above USD 1,000 require Finance approval; credits associated with a security incident additionally require Security & Compliance review.

Business hours

Standard business hours are Monday through Friday, 09:00-18:00 in the customer's contracted support timezone, excluding published regional holidays. Sev-1 and Sev-2 response targets operate continuously.

Measurement and exclusions

First response is measured from valid intake to an accountable human acknowledgement, not an automated receipt. Update cadence is measured between substantive customer updates. Time waiting for customer-requested postponement or missing customer authorization is excluded only when the pause reason and timestamps are recorded.

Required support workflow fields

FIELD	REQUIREMENT
Account context	Workspace ID, support tier, authorized contacts, region, and restrictions
Incident context	Severity, impact, observed start, affected scope, and workaround
Ownership	Incident owner, escalation owner, and next-update timestamp
Evidence	Correlation IDs, action receipts, approval decisions, and verification result
Outcome	Resolved, mitigated, escalated, duplicate, or customer action required

Escalation contacts

Customer Operations: customer-ops@northstar.example. Incident commander: incident-command@northstar.example. Security & Compliance: security@northstar.example. Finance approvals: finance-approvals@northstar.example.